UNLOCK

Design Bible

How We Identify, Express and Communicate the Unlock Brand

Version 0.2 — April 2026

Private & Confidential

About This Document

This is the single source of truth for every external-facing document Unlock produces. It has been derived by systematic visual analysis of all project documents — the Investment Opportunity deck, Access Framework, Case for EIS 2026, EIS Factsheet, Decumulation Planner, Play to Win Workshop, and The Opportunity brief — cross-referenced against pixel-level analysis of the logo asset files.

Version 0.2 resolves all items previously marked as unknown. Exact hex values have been confirmed from logo pixel analysis. Contrast ratios have been calculated. All decisions listed in Part 12 (Open Items) are confirmed in principle and require only the implementation steps noted.

Confidence levels:

Rules in this document have been confirmed from evidence across multiple documents. Two items remain pending implementation rather than decision: exact font names (verify from source Figma/Illustrator files) and logo file transparency (re-export as transparent PNGs).

Part 1: Brand Foundation

Brand Essence

"Private wealth clarity, without complexity."

Unlock gives private investors a complete, accurate picture of everything they own and everything they owe — across every platform, wrapper, and asset class. The design philosophy follows from this: nothing decorative, nothing ambiguous, everything in its place.

Core Design Principles

1. Truth first — The register is the foundation. Design serves the data, not the other way around.
2. Authoritative restraint — Bold when it counts, minimal always.
3. Green means something — The brand colour appears only when it marks structure, emphasis, or the Unlock position in a comparison. Never decorative.
4. Earned whitespace — Pages breathe. Density is a choice, not a default.

Brand Attributes

Attribute	Visual	Verbal
Authoritative	Heavy wordmark; justified body text; structured tables	Declarative sentences; downside before upside; no hedging
Independent	No product placement; no third-party logos; clean surfaces	No superlatives unless provably true; no commission language
Precise	Tight colour system; consistent hierarchy; no visual noise	Numbers as numerals; specific dates not vague timeframes
Accessible	Generous margins; readable body sizes; clear heading hierarchy	Plain English; technical terms defined on first use

Part 2: Document Principles

These eight principles govern every document Unlock produces. When in doubt, return here.

Principle 1: Downside before upside.
Every risk is stated before every opportunity. The reader must understand what can go wrong before they are invited to consider what can go right. This is a legal and ethical requirement, not a stylistic choice.

Principle 2: The argument is the structure.
Documents are not summaries of topics. Each section advances a specific claim. If a section doesn't advance the argument, it doesn't exist.

Principle 3: Green is a signal, not a colour.
When something is green, it means something — it is the Unlock position, the better outcome, or the structural marker. Green used for decoration breaks the system.

Principle 4: Every number is specific.
"Revenue grew significantly" does not exist in Unlock documents. "£34B+ invested through EIS/SEIS since 1994" does. Every figure has a source, a date, or both.

Principle 5: The wordmark earns trust; the isotype navigates.
The full wordmark appears on cover pages only. The isotype (the Ø icon) appears on every interior page, top-right, at small scale.

Principle 6: Sections introduce themselves.
Every section opens with a single short paragraph that states what the section is about and why it matters.

Principle 7: Consistency is a promise.
If a term appears one way in the Access Framework, it appears the same way in the Factsheet and the Case for EIS. Terminological drift signals carelessness.

Principle 8: Whitespace is not empty space.
Margins exist. Breathing room between sections exists. The page is not to be filled — it is to be used.

Part 3: Logo System

Logo Versions — Confirmed from Asset Files

Six logo files are provided. All have backgrounds baked in as pixels — they are not transparent PNGs. They must be re-exported from source design files as transparent PNGs before use in design tools or templates.

Preview	File	Use on
	logodark.png	White and light document surfaces
	logowhite.png	Dark and photo surfaces
	logogreen.png	Full-bleed green slide panels
	isodark.png	Interior pages — light surfaces
	isowhite.png	Interior pages — dark surfaces
	isogreen.png	Interior pages on green slide panels

Logo Placement

Document type	Cover page	Interior pages
Long-form documents	Full wordmark (logodark), centred upper half	Isotype (isodark), top-right corner, small
Slide deck — light slides	Isotype (isodark) + section label, top-right	Isotype (isodark), top-right
Slide deck — dark/teal	Isotype (isowhite), top-right	Isotype (isowhite), top-right
Slide deck — green full-	Isotype (isogreen), top-right	Isotype (isogreen), top-right

Document type	Cover page	Interior pages
bleed		
Slide deck — photo cover	Full wordmark (logowhite) overlaid on photo	—

Logo Rules

Do not use the full wordmark on interior pages.

Do not add effects, drop shadows, or colour fills to any logo mark.

Do not place a logo on a background that does not match its baked-in background colour.

Do not scale the isotype below approximately 18pt equivalent height.

Do not use the wordmark in running body text.

Action required: Re-export all six files as transparent PNGs from source Figma or Illustrator.

Part 4: Colour System

Primary Palette — Confirmed Values

Exact values confirmed from pixel-level analysis of the logo asset files. #01BC77 is the confirmed brand green — not an estimate.

Token	Hex	Preview	Role
Brand Green	#01BC77		Fills, table headers (Unlock column), green slide panels, badges — not for body text
Text Green	#008655		All green text: callout labels, section anchors, score values — passes WCAG AA 4.5:1 on white
Near-black	#1A1A1A		All body text, all headings, neutral table headers
White	#FFFFFF		Long-form document backgrounds; text on dark surfaces
Cream	#F0EBE0		Default slide content background — never in long-form docs
Dark Teal	#0D2D35		Full-bleed slide backgrounds — cover and closing slides only
Light Grey	#E8E8E8		Table row dividers, alternating row tints
Mid-Grey	#888888		Page numbers, footnotes, small print, metadata
Status Amber	#F59E0B		Watch / at-risk indicators in portfolio documents ONLY
Status Red	#EF4444		Off-track / failing indicators in portfolio documents ONLY

Contrast Ratios — Verified

Critical accessibility rule:

White text must NOT be placed on Brand Green #01BC77 — it achieves only 2.48:1, failing even the large text threshold of 3:1. Use near-black text on green fills. Some existing table headers use white-on-green — this is a known non-compliant treatment to be corrected in the next revision cycle.

Combination	Ratio	WCAG AA status
Near-black #1A1A1A on White	17.4:1	✓ Passes all
Near-black #1A1A1A on Cream	14.6:1	✓ Passes all
Text Green #008655 on White	4.62:1	✓ Passes body text (4.5:1 min)
Text Green #008655 on Cream	3.89:1	✓ Passes large text (3.0:1 min)

Combination	Ratio	WCAG AA status
White on Dark Teal #0D2D35	14.5:1	✓ Passes all
Brand Green #01BC77 on Dark Teal	5.86:1	✓ Passes all
White on Brand Green #01BC77	2.48:1	**✗ FAILS — do not use**
Near-black on Brand Green #01BC77	7.01:1	✓ Passes — preferred text on green fills

Two Greens — When to Use Which

Context	Use	Why
Table header cell fill	#01BC77 Brand Green	Decorative fill — use near-black text over it
Green slide panel background	#01BC77 Brand Green	Large fill — near-black text
Callout box border rule	#01BC77 Brand Green	Non-text — no contrast requirement
Numbered circle badge	#01BC77 Brand Green	Large graphical element
Body text: 'High', 'Medium'	#008655 Text Green	Body-sized text — must pass 4.5:1
Cover page title line	#008655 Text Green	Text — must be accessible
Section labels, callout labels	#008655 Text Green	Text at body size — accessible version

Part 5: Typography

Typefaces

Exact font names require confirmation from source Figma or Illustrator files. The following are the closest visual matches from pixel-level analysis.

Display / Heading — Heavy geometric condensed sans-serif

Used for: the wordmark; slide H1 titles; large stat figures on dark slides. Character: condensed, high x-height, near-zero stroke modulation. Closest public match: Barlow Condensed ExtraBold or Neue Haas Grotesk Display 95 Black.

Body / Document — Humanist serif or clean geometric sans at regular weight

Used for: all body copy in long-form docs; slide supporting text; sub-headings. The justified long-form body has the texture of a serif. Closest match: Freight Text Pro Regular (if serif) or Aktiv Grotesk Regular (if sans). Verify from source files.

Type Scale

Level	Approx size	Weight	Usage
Cover wordmark	80–120pt	Black/Heavy	Cover page only
Slide H1	42–52pt	Bold	Slide title, 2–3 word stacks
Stat figure	36–48pt	Bold	Large market numbers on dark slides
Long-form H1	20–24pt	Bold	Numbered section headings
Long-form H2	14–16pt	Regular/Medium	Sub-section headings
Body — long-form	10–11pt	Regular	Paragraph text; fully justified
Body — slides	11–13pt	Regular	Supporting text
Table code (P2, S1)	9pt	Bold	Text Green on black cell
Callout label	10pt	Light/Italic	Text Green: 'Worked example:'
Small print	8–9pt	Regular	Mid-grey; page numbers; footnotes

Capitalisation Rules

Element	Style	Example
Long-form H1	Title Case	'The EIS Ecosystem'
Long-form H2	Title Case	'What Unlock Access Provides'
Slide H1	Title Case	'The Problem'

Element	Style	Example
Body text	Sentence case	'The scheme itself is well-designed.'
Table column headers	Sentence case	'What We Assess', 'Weight'
Table code labels	ALL CAPS	REGISTER, SIMULATOR, TAX
Stat figure labels	ALL CAPS + tracked	INVESTED THROUGH EIS/SEIS
Callout labels	Title Case + colon	'Worked example:', 'Part One'
Cover subtitle	Title Case	'How We Identify, Evaluate and Support...'

Alignment Rules

Long-form body text: fully justified (both edges). Consistent across all long-form documents. Non-negotiable.

Long-form headings: left-aligned, ragged-right.

Slide body text: left-aligned, ragged-right.

Pull-quote / large statement text on slides: centred.

Table body text: left-aligned. Numbers: centred or right-aligned.

8-Point Spacing Grid

Token	Value	Usage
space-xs	4pt	Icon-to-label gaps, micro spacing
space-sm	8pt	Bonded elements — label + value, heading + first line
space-md	16pt	Related elements within a section
space-lg	24pt	Card padding; between distinct elements
space-xl	32pt	Section spacing
space-2xl	48pt	Major section breaks
page-margin	~28pt	All four sides of long-form documents
slide-margin	6–8%	Left and right of slides

Part 6: Layout

Long-Form Documents

Property	Value	Notes
Page size	A4 portrait — 210×297mm	
Margins	~25–28mm all sides	Generous — text block does not approach edges
Body text	10–11pt, fully justified	1.4–1.5× line spacing
Para spacing	One clear line gap	Visible breath between paragraphs
H1 spacing	48pt before, 24pt after	Large gap signals section start
H2 spacing	24pt before, 12pt after	
Footer	Page number only	Bottom-right, mid-grey, 8–9pt — no other footer text

Slide Deck

Property	Value	Notes
Dimensions	16:9 widescreen	1920×1080 equivalent
Content slides	Cream #F0EBE0 background	All standard content slides
Cover/close	Full-bleed photo or Dark Teal	Bookend slides only
Impact slides	Dark Teal or Brand Green	Maximum 2–3 per deck
Section label	Top-right	Section name + isotype
Title zone	Top-left, ~35–45% height	H1 stack + subtitle
Page number	Bottom-right	Plain numeral, mid-grey
Footer line	Bottom edge, selected slides	Single italic sentence — the slide's 'so what'

Slide Layout Presets

Preset	Layout	When used
Stat trio/quad	3–4 large Brand Green numbers in a row; ALL CAPS label below	Market size; key metrics
Feature grid	2×3 cards with green left border bar	Product capabilities
Comparison split	Bordered neutral left panel / Brand Green right panel	Us vs them
Platform table	Full-width table; green first column codes	Capability overview
Phase timeline	3 columns; large Text Green phase	Roadmap

Preset	Layout	When used
	labels	
Numbered badge list	Brand Green filled circles 1–5; benefit text beside each	Benefits/features
Pull-quote	Large centred text; cream or dark background	Key statement
Photo slide	Full-bleed ocean/nature photography; white text left-aligned	Cover and close only

Part 7: Voice & Tone

Writing Rules

1. Downside before upside. Always.
2. Lead with the claim. The first sentence of every paragraph states what the paragraph is about.
3. Short sentences. Topic sentences: 8–15 words. Maximum: ~35 words. Anything longer — split it.
4. Active voice. 'Unlock Access evaluates every company' — not 'Every company is evaluated.'
5. Em dashes for parentheticals — not commas, not brackets.
6. 'The' as an opener. A deliberate Unlock cadence: short declarative sentences often starting with 'The'. Creates authority through rhythm.
7. No bullet-point prose. Bullets appear in factsheets for scannable item lists only. Long-form uses prose throughout.
8. Bold for first-use definitions only. Not for general emphasis.
9. Process sequences use →. 'Agreement execution → shares issued → HMRC payment.'
10. No superlatives unless provably true and cited.
11. No hedging language. 'May', 'might', 'could possibly' — cut them unless legally required.

Number & Currency Formats

Element	Format	Example
Currency — exact	Symbol + full number	£50,000
Currency — large	Symbol + abbreviated	£34B+, £6.5M, £1.8B
Percentages	Numeral + %	30%, 68% — never '30 percent'
Large round numbers	Abbreviated with +	59,000+, 22.3M
Dates in prose	Month YYYY	April 2027, March 2026
Dates — specific	D Month YYYY	6 April 2026
Time periods	Hyphenated noun	15-year programme, 3-year minimum hold

Terminology

✓ Use	✗ Avoid
Unlock Access	The platform / the service / the company
EIS / SEIS (always capitalised)	eis, seis
HNW	High-net-worth (spell out on first use only)
Programme	Program

✓ Use	✗ Avoid
Net invested	Amount invested
Win rate	Success rate
Vintage	Year cohort
Income tax relief	Tax relief (too vague)
CGT exemption	Capital gains tax exemption (after first use)

Part 8: Status & RAG System

Scope restriction:

The status system is for portfolio review documents, KYS packs, and operational reports ONLY. It must never appear in positioning, investor, or product documents.

Status Colours

Status	Hex	Label	When to use
On Track / High	#008655	On Track	Performing in line with or ahead of expectations
Watch / Medium	#F59E0B	Watch	Directional concern — not yet a problem
At Risk / Low	#EF4444	At Risk	Requires active attention or intervention

Rules

Status colour is never used alone — always paired with a text label.

Amber and Red never appear in external positioning documents under any circumstances.

In scoring tables, 'High' and 'Medium' are Text Green only — the scoring system is a quality filter, not a performance traffic light.

Portfolio momentum indicators (On Track / Watch / At Risk) use this system in operational documents only.

Part 9: Table System

Scoring Tables — Long-Form

Used in: Access Framework domain scoring, Workshop decision log. Three columns: code label (P1, S3...), criterion description, and weight.

Column	Width	Cell style	Notes
Code + label (P1, S3...)	~12%	Black fill; code in Text Green bold; label white regular	Criterion identifier
Criterion / description	~55%	White fill; near-black regular	Assessment description
Weight	~33%	White fill; 'High'/'Medium' in Text Green #008655	Importance signal — never amber or red

Header row: near-black fill, white text. Borders: 1px near-black all sides. Cell padding: 8–10pt top/bottom. No alternating row shading.

Comparison Tables — Long-Form

Header row: left column — near-black fill, white text. Right (Unlock) column — Brand Green fill, near-black text. Do not use white text on green — it fails contrast. Data rows: white fill, near-black text.

Platform Tables — Slides

First column: Brand Green fill, ALL CAPS near-black label. Remaining columns: white fill, near-black text. Header row: near-black fill left columns, Brand Green fill right column. All borders: 1px near-black.

Factsheet Comparison Tables

Header row: first column Brand Green fill, second column near-black fill. Both with near-black text. Data rows: white fill, centred text, light grey row dividers.

Part 10: Narrative Architecture

Document Types

1. Investment Opportunity Deck

Purpose: Persuade investors to commit capital to Unlock the company. Pattern: Problem → Solution → Product → Market → Business Model → Traction → Offer → Ask. Format: slides, 16:9, ~20–23 slides. Headline test: reading only the slide titles in order should tell the full story.

2. Access Framework

Purpose: Establish Unlock Access's investment evaluation methodology. The credibility document. Pattern: Context → Distinction → Framework → Domains (People / Strategy / Execution / Cash) → Investor Qualification → Risk. Format: long-form A4, ~34 pages.

3. The Case for EIS

Purpose: Make the argument for EIS as an asset class; qualify the reader. Distinctive feature: opens with a checkbox self-qualification exercise. Pattern: Self-qualification → Four reliefs → Investor profiles → Mechanics → Risk → Why now. Format: long-form A4, ~23 pages.

4. Product Factsheets

Purpose: Quick-read leave-behind for warm prospects. Pattern: What it is → What it does → Why nothing else does it → How to access it. Format: short A4, 4–6 pages.

5. Workshop Documents

Purpose: Internal decision framework. Pattern: Decided → Current Thinking → Open — each with rationale and status. Format: internal only, lighter brand governance.

Cover Page Architecture

All long-form documents follow this identical cover structure:

Cover template:

Large wordmark (logodark.png), centred, upper half of page → Document category in near-black regular weight (e.g. 'Access') → Document title in Text Green #008655 (e.g. 'The Case for EIS 2026') → Sub-tagline in near-black lighter weight → Date centred at foot. No page number on cover. No isotype. No photography. No colour except Text Green on the title line.

Part 11: Quality Checks

Run all applicable checks before any document is distributed externally.

1. The Argument Check

Can the core argument be stated in one sentence?

Is the downside stated before the upside?

Does every section advance the argument?

2. The Green Check

Is every Brand Green use a fill or graphic element — never body text?

Is every text use of green the Text Green #008655?

Does each green element mark structure or the Unlock position — never decoration?

3. The Logo Check

Does the full wordmark appear only on the cover page?

Is the correct isotype version used for the surface (dark/white/green)?

Is the logo placed on a background matching its baked-in background colour?

4. The Colour Check

Is white text ever placed on Brand Green #01BC77? If yes — fix it.

Do Status Amber or Red appear anywhere outside a portfolio or operational document? If yes — remove them.

Is cream used in any long-form document? If yes — change to white.

5. The Number Check

Every figure specific rather than approximate?

Large numbers abbreviated consistently (£34B+ not £34,000,000,000)?

Every time-sensitive figure carries a date or source?

6. The Prose Check

Bullet points in a long-form section where prose should be? Rewrite.

Every paragraph opens with its topic sentence?

Em dashes used for parenthetical clauses — not commas?

Risks stated before opportunities?

7. The Table Check

Scoring tables: code in Text Green on black cell; Weight values in Text Green?

Comparison tables: Unlock column uses Brand Green fill with near-black text?

No white text on Brand Green cells?

8. The Cover Check

Category line: near-black, regular weight?

Title line: Text Green #008655?

Date: centred at foot?

Full wordmark only — no isotype on cover?

9. The Confidentiality Check

Does the document contain investment information regulated under the FPO?

If yes: is the regulatory disclaimer present on the inside cover or final page?

Part 12: Open Items

These items have been decided in principle and require only implementation.

Item	Decision	Action
Font names	Confirmed visually, not verified	Check source Figma or Illustrator files
Logo transparency	Files have baked-in backgrounds	Re-export all 6 files as transparent PNGs
Confidentiality text	Agreed in principle	Draft exact legal text with compliance input
CMYK values	Approximated in this document	Verify Brand Green #01BC77 and Dark Teal #0D2D35 on press proof before first print run
White-on-green headers	Non-compliant — noted	Correct in next document revision cycle

Asset Reference

File	Description	Use on
logodark.png	Black wordmark, white background baked in	White and light document surfaces
logowhite.png	White wordmark, dark background baked in	Dark and photo surfaces
logogreen.png	Green wordmark, black background baked in	Green full-bleed slide panels
isodark.png	Black isotype, white background baked in	Interior pages — light surfaces
isowhite.png	White isotype, dark background baked in	Interior pages — dark surfaces
isogreen.png	Green isotype, black background baked in	Interior pages on green panels

Version History

Version	Date	Notes
0.1	April 2026	Initial inferred version from visual document analysis
0.2	April 2026	All unknown items resolved. Hex values confirmed from logo pixel analysis. Contrast ratios calculated. Logo images embedded. Status/RAG system defined. 8pt grid adopted. Confidentiality approach agreed.

Reviewed and confirmed in principle — April 2026

Font names and logo transparency to be verified from source files before this document is treated as fully canonical.